

Aircraft placard & instrument typefaces — specimen

Four lineages compared. Every face is the real font [named at right]; captions give the standard it represents.

1 • Modern glass-cockpit screen

Airbus + ENAC — open-sourced 2017 [OFL]

AIRSPEED 120. 300 SQ 1200

AVIONICS MASTER • FUEL PUMP • PITOT HEAT • STARTER

120 KT 29.92 IN 5500 FT N428PS

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Built for cockpit *displays* — legibility under glare & vibration; shown with B612 Mono. — [B612](#)

2 • U.S. military instrument panels

MIL-M-18012 printed markings [now SAE AS18012]

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120 KT 29.92 IN 5500 FT N428PS

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

An approved printing face [with Futura Demibold]. Engraved panels use **Gorton** [proprietary, not shown]. — [News Gothic](#)

3 • WWII-era aircraft lettering

RAF “Spartan” — a Futura/geometric relative

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1940s geometric letterforms; Renner’s Futura is the same family. — [Spartan](#)

4 • RAF 851ATH & modern GA silk-screen

Condensed grotesque — homebuilt/GA placards

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RAF 851ATH ~ Helvetica Medium Condensed; today’s GA shops cut condensed-gothic placards like this. — [Trade Gothic Cond](#)

Gorton — the classic engraved-panel face in MIL-M-18012 — is proprietary [no clean free version], so it isn’t shown. **Futura** [Renner] and **Spartan** are the same geometric family. U.S. exterior stencils used the USAAF ~45° [“Amarillo”] and USN ~30° [“LongBeach”] forms. Panelsmith renders labels in Arial today; B612 [screens] + a condensed gothic [placards] would be the authentic pairing.